

Move to Columbus — Settling Pack

For people relocating to Columbus / Franklin County (and close suburbs). Print it. Check boxes. Ignore fluff.

Pre-move (2-4 weeks out)

- ☐ Confirm lease/start date and utility transfer windows
- ☐ Photo-document empty place condition on move-in day
- ☐ Set mail forwarding
- ☐ Get quotes: movers vs truck+friends
- ☐ Measure elevator / stair constraints
- ☐ Plan first-night kit (sheets, towels, toilet paper, charger, meds, snacks)
- ☐ Download: ParkColumbus (if relevant), COTA, weather, maps offline area

Neighborhood fit scorecard

Score 1-5. Total helps you compare 2-3 areas.

Factor	Area A ____	Area B ____	Area C ____
Commute to work			
Groceries walk/drive			
Noise tolerance fit			
Parking reality			
Weekend stuff nearby			
Budget fit (rent+fees)			
Total			

Common comparison set: Short North / Italian Village · German Village / Brewery · Clintonville · Grandview · Reynoldsburg / East side · Dublin / New Albany · Westerville · Grove City.

Week 1 setup

- ☐ Electric / gas / water / trash accounted for
- ☐ Internet installed or hotspot backup
- ☐ Renter's insurance binder saved offline
- ☐ Change address: bank, insurance, employer HR, subscriptions
- ☐ Ohio DL / ID update plan (if relocating from out of state)
- ☐ Vehicle registration / parking permit research for your street
- ☐ Find: pharmacy, urgent care, grocery, hardware
- ☐ Test smoke/CO detectors; buy batteries if needed
- ☐ Meet one neighbor or building manager on purpose

Local systems cheat sheet

Need	Where to start
City info / services	Columbus.gov
Income tax (city)	Confirm RITA / city withholding with employer payroll
Transit	COTA routes near home + work
Airport runs	CMH timing vs rideshare vs parking
Recycling rules	Your hauler's accepted list (don't assume)
Voters / records	Franklin County sites as needed

First-month budget worksheet

Category	Planned \$	Actual \$
Rent + fees		
Utilities		
Internet		
Groceries		
Transport / gas / rideshare		
Household setup buys		
Eating out		
Misc buffer		
Total		

Rule of thumb for month one: expect setup buys to overrun — protect the buffer line.

Day 30 check-in

- ☐ Emergency contacts on fridge / phone favorites
- ☐ Primary care / dentist search started
- ☐ One "regular" coffee or grocery routine established
- ☐ Know your street's overnight parking / snow rules
- ☐ Have a severe weather plan (basement / interior room)
- ☐ Social: one recurring local activity on calendar (league, meetup, class, faith, hobby)

Packing priority for Columbus seasons

Bring sooner than you think:

- ☐ Solid rain jacket
- ☐ Ice scraper if you have a car
- ☐ Door mat (salt / mud season)

- ☐ Window covers for summer heat

Done looks like

You can answer: where you buy food, how you get to work, what happens in a storm, and who you'd text locally if something breaks.